

David Ruiz

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Profile

Senior Data/AI/ML professional, 13 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: PyTorch, Docker, Python.

Academic Background

Bachelor, Electrical Engineering

Amberton University | 2011
GPA 3.6/4.0

Tech Stack

PyTorch	
Docker	
Python	
Pandas	
Databricks	
Snowflake	
Hugging Face	
AWS	
Kafka	
Jenkins	
Confluence	
Angular	
Ruby	

Career History

AI Researcher, Summit Digital

2018–2026

- Lifted recommendation click-through by 22% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in PyTorch.
- Trained and deployed PyTorch models serving 20M predictions per day at under 40ms p95.
- Translated ambiguous business questions into a modelling roadmap with product and finance stakeholders.
- Mentored 5 analysts moving into modelling work, with weekly paper reading and code review.
- Wrote the team's model documentation and review standard, now required before any production launch.

Airbnb — Applied Scientist

2014–2018

- Reduced label noise by redesigning the annotation guidelines, improving validation accuracy by 30%.
- Built the feature store that 4 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.
- Established offline/online evaluation parity, catching 8 silent regressions before release.
- Productionised demand forecasting models that reduced stock-outs by 18% across 20 regions.

Junior Data Scientist

Vantage Point Technologies | 2014–2014

- Cut inference cost by 55% through quantisation, batching and autoscaling on Jenkins.
- Developed an NLP classification system in Databricks reaching 90% F1, replacing a manual review queue.
- Ran A/B tests across 40 model variants; the winning variant added an estimated \$400k in annual revenue.

Junior MLOps Engineer, Ironwood Consulting

2012–2013

- Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned Python pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.
- Built an end-to-end training pipeline on Pandas, cutting retraining from days to 40 hours.
- Managed stakeholder communication during a major incident, including the post-mortem.

Personal Interests

Cooking, Bouldering, Volunteering at a local coding club

References available upon request.